

White Snow Bright Snow

Searchable transcript

****Author:**** Alvin Tresselt, illustrated by Roger Duvoisin

Author: Alvin Tresselt, illustrated by Roger Duvoisin

Source: `White Snow, Bright Snow (Alvin Tresselt).pdf` (38 PDF pages; story on PDF pages 5-33 with a closing verse on PDF page 36)

Prepared: 9 September 2026

> Internal school working copy prepared from a school-accessible PDF. Keep with the restricted book files. Do not publish this transcript in GitHub, Supabase, or the public progress viewer.

Softly, gently in the secret night,
Down from the North came the quiet white.
Drifting, sifting, silent flight,
Softly, gently, in the secret night.
White snow, bright snow, smooth and deep.
Light snow, night snow, quiet as sleep.
Down, down, without a sound;
Down, down, to the frozen ground.
Covering roads and hiding fences,
Sifting in cracks and filling up trenches
Millions of snowflakes, tiny and light,
Softly, gently, in the secret night.

The postman said it looked like snow. The farmer said it smelled like snow.

The policeman said it felt like snow, and his wife said her big toe hurt, and that always meant snow.

Even the rabbits knew it, and scurried around in the dead leaves. While the children watched the low grey sky, waiting for the first snowflake to fall. Then, just when no one was looking, it come. One flake, two flakes, five, eight, ten, and suddenly the air was filled with soft powdery snowflakes, whispering quietly as they sifted down.

The postman put on his rubbers. The farmer went to the barn for a snow shovel.

The policeman buttoned up his coat. His wife made sure she had cough mixture in the medicine cabinet.

But the children laughed and danced, trying to catch the lacy snowflakes on their tongues. While the rabbits hid in their warm burrows under the ground.

Faster and faster came the tiny snowflakes, and the brown earth turned white.

Fields and stone walls, roads and gutters, lawns and sidewalks, all were buried under the soft white snow. It covered the roofs of houses, and piled on top of chimneys. It filled the cold tree branches with great white blossoms. And when night came, icy cold snowflakes sparkled in the light of the street lamps.

The postman slipped and fell into a snow bank. The farmer dug a path from his house to the barn.

The policeman got his feet wet, and had to soak them in a tub of hot water. His wife put a mustard plaster on his chest so he wouldn't catch cold.

The rabbits stirred in their sleep, deep in their warm burrows under the ground, under the snow. And the children dreamed of snow houses and snow-men as they slept in their snug

beds under the roof-tops, under the snow. Silently, the frost made pictures of ice ferns on the window panes. Then without a sound, just when everybody was asleep, the snow stopped, and bright stars filled the night.

In the morning a clear blue sky was overhead and blue shadows hid in all the corners. Automobiles looked like big fat raisins buried in snowdrifts. Houses crouched together, their windows peeking out from under great white eyebrows. Even the church steeple wore a pointed cap on its top.

The postman put away his rubbers and took out his high boots. The farmer milked his cows in a barn filled with bright snow-light.

The policeman had a chill, and stayed in bed. His wife sat in a rocker and knitted a long woolen scarf for him.

The rabbits hopped about as best they could, making long funny rabbit tracks in the soft snow. The children made a snowman, a snow house, a snow fort, and then had a snowball fight.

The wind pushed light puffs of white from the branches, while the melting snow on roof-tops drip-drip-dripped into long shiny icicles. Each day the sun grew stronger, and the snow melted. Big patches of soft muddy ground showed through the snow in the fields. The sound of dripping, running water and the smell of wet brown earth filled the warm air. Now the branches were bare again and grey pussy willows pushed out of their brown shells. Fence posts lost their dunce caps, the snowman's arms dropped off, and running water gurgled in gutters and rain pipes.

The postman slowly delivered his mail so he could enjoy the bright sunshine. The farmer let his cows out in the barnyard for the first time since winter began.

The policeman's cold was better, and he swung his club in the air as he walked in the park. His wife dug around under the lilac bush, looking for the snowdrops and crocuses that grew there.

While the rabbits spent all their time hopping about in the warm world above the ground.

And the children watched for the first robin to tell them spring had really come.

White snow, bright snow, smooth and deep.

Light snow, night snow, quiet as sleep.

Down, down, without a sound;

Down, down, to the frozen ground.

- The opening spreads show the first snowfall arriving at night, with the postman, farmer, policeman, children and rabbits each sensing it in turn.
- The middle spreads show the snow-covered town -- buried roads and roofs, snow blossoms on branches, sparkling street lamps -- and each character coping with the storm.
- The night-and-morning spreads show frost ferns on windowpanes, star-filled skies, and the transformed morning world of snowdrifts, eyebrow windows and the capped church steeple.
- The closing spreads show the melt -- dripping icicles, muddy fields, pussy willows, the snowman losing its arms -- and the town welcoming spring.

Story text transcribed from the embedded text layer (PDF pages 5-33 and the closing verse on page 36), joined across line breaks. The opening and closing verses were kept line-by-line as

printed. Cover matter, the publisher's edition and copyright matter (page 2), title page (page 3), contents table (page 4) and the publisher review request (page 37) are not included as story prose. Pixel-level visual verification against the rendered scans has not yet been completed -- my image-reading tool is currently unavailable, so please check the transcript against the PDF before treating it as final.